Specification of the controlled designation of origin “CROZES-HERMITAGE” or “CROZES-ERMITAGE”

Approved by order of 10 December 2024 published in the JORF of 12 December 2024

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Crozes-Hermitage” or “Crozes-Ermitage”, initially recognised by the decree of 4 March 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin “Crozes-Hermitage” or “Crozes-Ermitage” is reserved for still white and red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines take place in the geographical area approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 2 June 1989.

The perimeter of this area, at the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2019:

Drôme department:

Communes retained in full: Beaumont-Monteux, Chanos-Curson, Crozes-Hermitage, Erôme, Gervans, Larnage, Pont-de-l’Isère, La Roche-de-Glun, Serves-sur-Rhône and Tain-l’Hermitage.

Commune retained in part: Mercurol-Veaunes for the sole territory of the delegated commune of Mercurol.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The grapes come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 2 June 1989.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2019:

Ardèche department: Alboussière, Andance, Ardoix, Arlebosc, Arras-sur-Rhône, Boffres, Bogy, Champagne, Champis, Charmes-sur-Rhône, Charnas, Châteaubourg, Cheminas, Colombier-le- Cardinal, 2/12 Publié au BO agri du MASAF le 19 décembre 2024 Cornas, Eclassan, Etables, Félines, Gilhac-et-Bruzac, Glun, Guilherand-Granges, Lemps, Limony, Mauves, Ozon, Peaugres, Peyraud, Plats, Quintenas, Saint-Barthélemy-le-Plain, Saint-Cyr, Saint-Georges- les-Bains, Saint-Romain-d’Ay, Saint-Romain-de-Lerps Sarras, Sécheras, Serrières, Saint-Désirat, Saint- Etienne-de-Valoux, Saint-Jean-de-Muzols, Saint-Péray, Soyons, Talencieux, Thorrenc, Toulaud, Tournon- sur-Rhône, Vernosc-lès-Annonay, Vinzieux et Vion

Drôme department: Albon, Andancette, Beausemblant, Bourg-lès-Valence, Chantemerle-les- Blés, Châteauneuf-sur-Isère, Chavannes, Clérieux, Granges-les-Beaumont, Laveyron, La Motte-de- Galaure, Ponsas Saint-Barthélemy-de-Vals, Saint-Donat-sur-l'Herbasse, Saint-Rambert-d'Albon, Saint-Uze, Saint-Vallier, Triors, Valence et Mercurol-Veaunes for the sole territory of the delegated commune of Veaunes

Isère department: Chonas-l'Amballan, Le Péage-de-Roussillon, Reventin-Vaugris, Les Roches- de-Condrieu, Sablons, Saint-Alban-du-Rhône, Saint-Clair-du-Rhône, Saint-Maurice-l'Exil, Salaise-sur-Sanne, Seyssuel, Vienne

Loire department: Bessey, La Chapelle-Villars, Chavanay, Chuyer, Lupé, Maclas, Malleval, Pélussin, Roisey, Saint-Michel-sur-Rhône, Saint-Pierre-de-Bœuf, Saint-Romain-en-Jarez et Vérin

Rhône department: Ampuis, Condrieu, Les Haies, Loire-sur-Rhône, Longes, Sainte-Colombe, Saint-Cyr-sur-le-Rhône, Saint-Romain-en-Gal et Tupin-et-Semons

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The red wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: syrah N; - accessory varieties: marsanne B, roussanne B.

b) – The white wines come from the marsanne B and roussanne B varieties.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

a) – For the red wines, the proportion of the syrah N variety is greater than or equal to 85 % of the grape varieties of the holding. The presence of the accessory varieties is authorised as a mixture of plants in the vines planted with syrah N within the limit of a proportion of 15 % of the plants.

b) – The conformity of the grape varieties of the holding is assessed over the totality of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin and taking into account the situation of the parcels co-planted with a white variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.
- The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare; - Each plant has a maximum area of 2.50 square metres; this area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and inter-plant distances; - The vines present a spacing between rows less than or equal to 2.50 metres. The vine parcels may present alleys of a width greater than 2.5 metres.

The provisions relating to the maximum area per plant and to the minimum planting density do not apply to the vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009, which present a distance between rows of, on average over the parcel, between 2.50 m and 2.75 m, subject to the limitation of the average maximum load per parcel, as provided for by the provisions of point d of this article, and of the yield, as well as of the limit yield, provided for in paragraphs VIII.1 and 2.

b) – Pruning rules.
- The vines are short-pruned with spurs (goblet, Royat cordon with one or two arms), with a maximum of 10 free eyes (buds) per plant; - The establishment period of the Royat cordon is limited to 2 years; - The maximum height of the cordon is 0.60 metre; this height is measured from the ground to the lower part of the framework arms. - The roussanne B and marsanne B varieties may in addition be pruned in single Guyot with a maximum of 8 free eyes on the long cane and a spur with a maximum of 2 free eyes.

c) – Trellising, foliage-height and staking-height rules.
The vines are trained either on stakes or in "raised single-plane trellising": - For vines trained in "raised single-plane trellising", the height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows. The height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least

0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit; - For vines trained on stakes, the staking height is at least 1.50 metre. This height is measured between the ground level and the top of the stake.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 8,500 kilograms per hectare. - Where irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 6,000 kilograms per hectare. - For the parcels whose spacing between rows is, on average, between 2.50 and 2.75 m, referred to in paragraph VI-1.a, the average maximum load per parcel is limited to 6,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Thresholds for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir: - On the parcels apt for the production of the controlled designation of origin, the works for controlling water flow and the elements ensuring the integrity and durability of the soils (low walls, terraces, banks, etc.) are maintained according to usage; - Only developments or works that do not bring a substantial modification of the structuring elements (low walls, terraces, embankments, banks, etc.) of a parcel of the delimited parcel area are authorised; - The control of the spontaneous vegetation is carried out, from 1 September to 1 February, either by soil tillage or by equipment ensuring a precise localisation of the treatment products; - Plastic mulching of the vines is prohibited; - The weeding of the headlands and embankments, other than mechanical weeding, is prohibited; - Full weeding with herbicides other than biocontrol herbicides is prohibited for the parcels with an inter-row on average greater than 1.80 metre.

b) – From the 2021/2022 campaign, vine plantings and replacements are carried out with plant material that has been the subject of a hot-water treatment or of any other treatment recognised by the Ministry responsible for Agriculture to combat flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

In application of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, irrigation during the growing period of the vine may be authorised in the event of persistent drought and where this disturbs the good physiological development of the vine and the good ripeness of the grape. Any fixed irrigation installation situated inside the plantings is prohibited. “Fixed irrigation installation” means any irrigation installation present on a vine parcel outside the authorised irrigation period.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than the following may not be considered as being at proper ripeness: - 161 grams per litre of must for the white wines; - 171 grams per litre of must for the red wines.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 10.5 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 45 hectolitres per hectare. For the parcels whose spacing between rows is, on average, between 2.50 and 2.75 m, referred to in paragraph VI-1.a, the yield is limited to 40 hl/ha.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 50 hectolitres per hectare. For the parcels whose spacing between rows is, on average, between 2.50 and 2.75 m, referred to in paragraph VI-1.a, the limit yield is limited to 40 hl/ha.

3° – Loss of the benefit of the controlled designation of origin

The wines are obtained within the limit of a yield of 63 hectolitres per hectare. This yield corresponds to the total production of the claimed parcels. Any exceeding of this yield causes the whole of the harvest to lose the benefit of the controlled designation of origin.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local usages.

a) – Blending of varieties. For the red wines, the proportion of the syrah N variety is greater than or equal to 85 % of the blend, and the wines elaborated from the white varieties and the syrah N variety are vinified by blending of the grapes concerned, respecting this same proportion.

b) – Malolactic fermentation. The red wines present, at the packaging stage, a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards. At the packaging stage: - the wines present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre, for wines presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 13.5 %, and less than or equal to 4 grams per litre for wines presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 13.5 %; - Before 1 December of the year following that of the harvest, the wines present a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 15.30 milliequivalents per litre (which corresponds to 0.75 g/l of sulphuric acid). Beyond that, the wines present a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 18 milliequivalents per litre (which corresponds to 0.88 g/l of sulphuric acid).

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %. - The use of pieces of wood is prohibited.

e) – Prohibited equipment. Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Vat capacity. Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equal to 0.8 times the product of the yield referred to at 1° of point VIII by the area of the vines intended to be vinified at the cellar.

g) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floor and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates an identified place for the storage of the packaged products.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumers

The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is located to the north of the town of Valence, opposite the commune of Tournon, on the left bank of the Rhône, the river constituting its western limit. To the north, the classified site known as the "Cromlech-de-la-Roche-qui-danse" (Tertiary sandstone rocks marking the junction with the Secondary) bounds the geographical area. To the east and the south, the natural frontiers are constituted respectively by the rivers of the Herbasse and of the Isère. The geographical area is thus delimited over 11 communes of the Drôme department.

Largely open onto the Rhône Valley, this vineyard is one of the most southern among the vineyards grouped within the controlled designations of origin known as those of the "northern Côtes du Rhône". In the organisation of the controlled designations of origin of the Rhône Valley, the controlled designation of origin "Crozes-Hermitage" is part of the "Crus des Côtes du Rhône". To the south of the commune of Tain-l'Hermitage, the Mediterranean influences are more marked, characterised by good sunshine and high average temperatures. The precipitation regime is fairly balanced over the whole and allows the maintenance of a water regime and a water resource particularly adapted to the cultivation of the vine, with the exception of the sector known as the "Chassis", where the rolled pebbles rest on soils whose low useful water reserve may sometimes provoke a water stress of the vine. Formerly, this whole region was moreover dedicated to arboriculture and abundantly irrigated.

The contrast between the North and the South of the geographical area expresses itself both at the level of the relief and of the geological formations. In the northern part, its perimeter has the particularity of adjoining that of the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage" with a geomorphology that resembles the latter. The Rhône becomes entrenched there between the communes of Crozes-Hermitage and Serves-sur-Rhône, revealing a substrate of Primary age made up of "Tournon granite" identical to that encountered on the eponymous commune situated on the other bank of the river, which is inscribed in the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Saint-Joseph". The clayey sands, granitic arenas, unstable, arising from this substrate are held on the hillsides thanks to the development of terraces supported by low walls traditionally of dry stone. The vineyard here resembles the hillsides of the controlled designations of origin "Saint-Joseph", "Côte-Rôtie" or "Condrieu".

Further to the south and the east, the territory is less rugged, flatter and more open, made up of a succession of terraces of the Quaternary era, composed of gravels arising from the erosion of the neighbouring Alpine massifs. The highest altitudes coincide with the oldest terraces to the north of the communes of Mercurol and Chanos-Curson. Certain high points of this sector are occasionally covered with loess (aeolian deposits taken up again by erosion and recalcified, as in the quarter known as the "Blancs" at Gervans). More recent intermediate levels are encountered on the commune of Crozes-Hermitage and above all of Mercurol, where they form the famous "Coteau des Pends".

This southern part, the most important in delimited and planted area, corresponds to the lowest, the most recent level. It rests on the terrace known as the "Chassis" which covers the territory of several communes to the south of the departmental road no. 532 linking Tain-l'Hermitage to Romans-sur-Isère. This terrace

forms a triangle whose apex is constituted by the commune of Pont-de-l'Isère, at the confluence of the Rhône and the Isère.

Finally, anecdotally and only over a part of the commune of Larnage, sedimentary detrital formations of the Bas-Dauphiné have given rise to singular soils made up of kaolinic sands, very white.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Much evidence attests, on the one hand to the Roman presence around the commune of Tain-l'Hermitage (the "Taurobolium of Tain-l'Hermitage", the vestiges of the temple of Hercules between the present communes of Tain-l'Hermitage and Mercurol, etc.) and on the other hand to the anteriority of the cultivation of the vine and of wine in the Rhône Valley. Indeed, "Crozes-Hermitage", like the whole perimeter of the present controlled designations of origin inscribed within the northern part of the "Côtes du Rhône", belonged to the territory of the Allobroges. On this territory, the cultivation of the vine would go back at least to the period of the Roman occupation, namely between 124 BC (submission of the Allobroges) and 61 BC (defeat of the last revolt of the Allobroges). From this date, the Allobroges become Viennese, or the city of Vienne. While the geographer STRABO evokes the cultivation of the vine in the Rhône Valley in 30 BC, without, however, specifying its northern limit, on the other hand numerous ancient authors including the physician CELSUS, the naturalist PLINY THE ELDER, the historian PLUTARCH, the agronomist COLUMELLA and the poet MARTIAL mention "l'Allobrogica", a wine of Vienne produced among the Allobroges. "L'Allobrogica" also designates a variety whose DNA study reveals its kinship with the syrah N variety, itself emblematic of this viticultural territory.

The controlled designation of origin "Crozes-Hermitage" obviously takes its name from the eponymous commune. Yet, before being thus recognised, it was named "Crozis" (1240), "Croisis" (1285) or "Crosis" (1344), to take in the 17th century the name of "Crozes" or "Croses", a commune of the canton of Tain. On the CASSINI map (18th century), the hillsides of "l'Hermitage" already appear, but the communes that compose it are still named "Tain" and "Croses" without reference to the Hermitage. The name of Crozes-Hermitage, like that of Tain-l'Hermitage (a neighbouring commune), derive from the name given to the famous and prestigious hillside of the Hermitage recognised as the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage". Crozes therefore only became Crozes-Hermitage very belatedly, by a decree of 14 May 1920. Upon recognition as a controlled designation of origin by decree of 4 March 1937, only this commune may benefit from the denomination "Crozes-Hermitage". Numerous writings corroborate the link between the existence of hermits and the change of name of the hillside known as "Saint-Christophe" to the "hillside of the Ermitage", which would later give its name to the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage" and to the communes cited.

The syrah N, marsanne B and roussanne B (more anecdotal) varieties are emblematic varieties and are the only ones authorised in the controlled designations of origin known as those of the "northern Côtes du Rhône" on the left bank of the Rhône. The know-how of man has been to adapt this restricted choice of varieties to a palette of diversified soils. Thus, the syrah N variety, or "petite syrah", is very predominantly established (90 % of the grape varieties). In addition, a clone locally called "syrah de Gervans" is present in all these vineyards. The white varieties, marsanne B and roussanne B, are less represented but often established in fiefs of predilection where they have found terrains conducive to their adaptation (white calcareous soils of the sector of the commune of Crozes-Hermitage and Mercurol, kaolinic sands of Larnage, etc.).

From 1881, the winegrowers mobilise to rebuild the vineyard ravaged by the phylloxera crisis. At this period the first unions are born, and notably the agricultural union of Tain-l'Hermitage (1890). The economic recession and the wine crisis, due to the overproduction that rages between 1920 and 1930, oblige the human community to organise itself. The main production structures, or those representative of the producers, driving forces of viticulture at Tain-l'Hermitage, date from this difficult period: the "Union of the winegrowers of the canton of Tain-l'Hermitage, producers of great wines" (1927), the cooperative cellar of fine wines of Tain-l'Hermitage (1933).

The decree of 4 March 1937 limits the geographical area to a part of the territory of the commune of Crozes-Hermitage. Already at this period, the text stipulates explicitly that a deficient physical environment or the absence of human factors are redhibitory and imply the exclusion of certain sectors of the commune: "with the exception of the terrains of modern alluvium and of those not intended for the

cultivation of the vine, by reason of local usages". In addition, a nomenclature of the quarters makes it possible to trace precisely the limits of the original geographical area: "Bourret, Les Habrards, Martinet, Les Méjeans". The prosperity of the post-war years, the sharing of know-how and the extension of the vineyard lead to the enlargement of the geographical area, which goes from a single commune to 11 communes as early as 1952. In the 1990s, the context has changed; the producers become aware of the necessity of refocusing the vineyard on more qualitative terrains. The work lasts 10 years, before, in June 1989, a new selection of the parcels from which the grapes come is ratified. This reduces the production potential from 4,800 hectares to only 3,200 hectares. In 2019, with a volume of 80,400 hectolitres of average annual production for an exploited area of 1,700 hectares, "Crozes-Hermitage" is the most important controlled designation of origin of the northern part of the "Côtes du Rhône". The wines are elaborated by 57 private cellars, 2 cooperative cellars and 9 merchants.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The "Atlas de la France Vinicole" of L. LARMAT (1943 edition) offers a flattering description of the wines written by a certain Doctor RAMAIN: the red wines have "a magnificent aroma of raspberry and wild hawthorn" and the white wines are qualified as "charming wines".

The geomorphological variations observed between the North and the South of the geographical area are also found in the wines, the winegrowers having known and continuing to take advantage of these by the adaptation of their usages of vineyard management and of vinification. Thus taking advantage of the natural variations of the natural environment and of the induced effects on the wines, the controlled designation of origin rests on red wines, produced in the south, agreeable, aromatic, of good structure but without excess and of medium keeping, as much as on wines from the hillsides, in the north, which have, for certain cuvées, more structure and more resistance to ageing. For the whole of the red wines, the robe is dark garnet, taking on more orange nuances with ageing.

The white wines, more discreet in volume, present a clear robe with green glints which, with ageing, takes on more sustained and golden notes. Depending on the know-how implemented, notably in the control of the malolactic fermentation, they may: - either present an intense aromatic expression, marked by fresh fruits recalling citrus, a good liveliness, and are then to be consumed in their youth in order to preserve the freshness of these aromas; - or have a more floral and spicy aromatic expression, a balance more on the fat, and thus improve after a medium keeping.

3° – Causal interactions

On the left bank of the Rhône, the conjunction, on the one hand of a "lyonnais" climate and of a latitude close to the 45th parallel offering situations still benefiting from Mediterranean influences, with a contrasted topography of hillsides and large flat expanses, and on the other hand of varied geological formations from crystalline rocks to Quaternary terraces, offers the three emblematic varieties of the region (syrah N, marsanne B and roussanne B) optimal conditions of development and ripeness.

These conditions of ripeness allow the expression of an originality that characterises these wines, close cousins of those of the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage" but nevertheless differentiated notably by red wines of a more supple structure and white wines that are more contrasted. The tasting committee of the 1846 Lyon wine congress (Atlas de la France Vinicole of L. Larmat, 1943 edition) compares "Crozes-Hermitage" to its prestigious neighbour "Hermitage": "If it is not a brother, it is a first cousin, assuredly". In 1943, the official review of the sommeliers of Paris "Le Sommelier" refers to the wines of the region of the Hermitage and thus proves that they already had a certain renown both for the red wines and for the white wines. For the red and white wines, it evokes, of course, the commune of Crozes-Hermitage, alongside communes or geographical sectors such as "Château-Larnage, Chassis" for the red wines, or "Mercurol" for the white wines. Beyond these elements, it seems that the qualities of the wines of "Crozes-Hermitage" have often been merged into a common expression, "wines of the Hermitage", encompassing under this term the controlled designations of origin "Hermitage" and "Crozes-Hermitage". Thus, the direct sources referring explicitly to the reputation or the renown of the wines of "Crozes-Hermitage" are few in number.

The dynamism of the human communities has made possible the constant improvement of the wines by the pooling of the production and marketing tools through a strong cooperative system, then by the development of numerous private cellars in close relation with the local merchant houses. The organisation

of these people around a common product carried the recognition as a controlled designation of origin as early as 1937, that is to say only two years after the first possibilities of recognition.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density. The vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009 and not meeting the provisions relating to the minimum planting density and to the distance between rows or the spacing between plants within the same row continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2030 harvest.

b) – Pruning rules. The provision relating to the height of the cordon does not apply to the vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009.

2° – Other cultivation practices

The provision relating to the prohibition of plastic mulching does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Crozes-Hermitage” or “Crozes-Ermitage” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that: - it is a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appears on the harvest declaration.

b) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit “Cru des Côtes du Rhône” or “Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône”. The conditions of use of the larger geographical unit “Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône” are specified by the agreement signed between the various defence and management bodies concerned. This term must appear in the same visual field as all the compulsory indications, and be printed in characters of the same graphics and the same colour as those of the appellation, without the dimensions of this term exceeding two-thirds of those of the appellation.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, according to the arrangements defined in the control plan, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. The declaration of renunciation to produce is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

2. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before the first bulk transaction or bulk sale to the consumer, or before the first packaging, and at the latest five days after the deadline for lodging the harvest declaration. The claim declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body. It indicates in particular: - the designation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine.

3. Declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

A declaration of bulk transaction, or a declaration of bulk sale to the consumer, is sent to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration specifies, where applicable, whether the non-packaged wine is intended to be dispatched outside the national territory. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the approved control body.

4. Packaging declaration

Every operator having carried out a packaging of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make, to the approved control body, a packaging declaration according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. The packaging declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the approved control body.

5. Fallback (repli) declaration (marketing under a more general appellation)

Every operator carrying out a fallback of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

7. Declaration relating to the modification of the structuring elements of the parcels

Before any development or any works modifying the structuring elements (low walls, terraces, embankments, banks, etc.) of a delimited parcel, a declaration is sent by the operator to the defence and management body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

II. – Keeping of registers

Every operator intervening in the production of the wines of the controlled designation of origin undertakes to fill in the following register and to keep it available for the defence and management body and the approved control body.

Register relating to planting density

List of the vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009 which present a distance between rows of, on average over the parcel, between 2.50 m and 2.75 m.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary checks (up-to-date parcel record) and, where applicable, checks in the field
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density and trellising)	Documentary checks and checks in the field
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	

Place of vinification	Documentary checks
Identified storage place for the packaged products	Documentary checks and on-site checks
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning	Checks in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Checks in the field
Cultivation condition and other cultivation practices	Checks in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes	Documentary checks and checks in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	Documentary checks and checks in the field
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	Documentary checks (register keeping) and checks in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary checks (check of declarations, monitoring of the authorised derogations)
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary checks (monitoring of destruction certificates)
Claim declaration	Documentary checks and checks in the field (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration, production declaration, etc.). Control of the placing into circulation of the products
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines moving between approved warehouse keepers, at transaction	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Wines ready to be placed on the market for the consumer, before or after packaging	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots

II – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL CEDEX
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, having received delegation from the INAO.